

Docket No. 20-15, Comments on PVO Financial Responsibility Rulemaking

I would like to support holding travel agencies to a standard that is fair to the consumer. I think the requirement to refund a customer when their arrangements are canceled should be required. Our travel agency is trying to force its customers to rebook even though the European area is still closed or severely restricted to non-residents. The funds have already been encumbered starting in July, 2019 with the trip starting in March, 2020. The trip was postponed and rescheduled several times and ultimately canceled on September 21, 2021. At this point, the avenue for refund is very difficult. A rule such as this would have prevented the travel agency from threatening to keep the \$29,712.00 we paid in good faith to them for this cruise vacation.

Please keep the avenues open for fair treatment of the customer. A travel agency should not be able to operate a virtual ponzi scheme where they use other customers money to book my travel. I believe that when Covid-19 stopped travel, there was no money coming in. Therefore, they wouldn't refund because they had already used our money for someone else. Not an honest practice if they can not cover their debt. Also, the Terms & Conditions of this particular trip should have guaranteed a refund but that is not being honored. If there was a rule like the one being proposed, hopefully this would not happen.

Our group will never sign up for a cruise vacation under the current rules. They are too risky. Even the travel insurance failed in our instance stating that they were not liable. So in all, 3 people are out of pocket around \$33,000 after travel agency charges, insurance and lost reservation arrangements with the airlines. That should not be fair or able to happen.

Thank you for trying to make this portion of travel better for everyone.